



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Highland Rim Academy

School Website: <https://highlandrimacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Highland Rim Academy (HRA) presents a robust CLASSICAL profile across all six classical criteria. Public materials consistently foreground a distinctly Christian, Protestant worldview and a classical framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the backbone of education. The school emphasizes formation of character and virtue, not merely information, and explicitly centers on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. Great Books / classical resources are integrated into its curricular philosophy, and teaching methods span from memory- and chant-oriented routines in the early grades to Socratic-style engagement in the upper grades, with an explicit emphasis on disciplined study, catechesis, and disciplined behavior. Family partnerships and parental formation are positioned as core to the mission, with frequent reminders that parents are co-educators and are welcomed into the school community.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Key takeaways: HRA openly commits to a Christian-formative, virtue-centered education grounded in the classical Trivium; the curriculum foregrounds grammar, logic, rhetoric, and Great Books; pedagogy blends memory-based routines in younger years with higher-order dialogue; faculty are framed as moral exemplars within a living-curriculum model; parents are invited into partnership and formation.

Evidence spans multiple public-facing pages and materials, including our Vision & Statement of Faith, the "Why Classical?" page, admissions and program descriptions, and parent-focused materials. See representative lines and sections cited in the category-by-category breakdown below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site proclaims a distinctly Christian, Protestant-Christian worldview as the governing frame for all programs and activities. It identifies Highland Rim Academy as a "fully accredited K-12 Protestant classical Christian school," and emphasizes fidelity to God's Word as foundational. - The Vision & Statement of Faith section articulates a gospel-centered aim, including beliefs about Scripture and God, and ties education to spiritual formation. - Materials emphasize the centrality of Christ and a biblical worldview in home-school partnership, with explicit invitations to families who share that commitment. - The "Why Christian?" and "What's Different?" sections reinforce a religious framing for the educational project and formation of character.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, God's Word, gospel, Christian worldview, Scripture, faith, church/home discipleship, proclamation of faith, Protestant. - Negative keywords:

none evident in public-facing materials (no explicit secular or relativistic framing detected in the published pages reviewed).

Why this rating - The materials announce a transcendent, theologically grounded foundation (theology and sacred truths) and a liturgical/community rhythm implicit in the Christian formation emphasis. The explicit statements about Scripture, gospel, and Christian worldview align with Positive keyword indicators for a high-level Religious and Metaphysical Foundations alignment. The absence of countervailing secular or relativistic signals reinforces a CLASSICAL placement in this category. CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The stated aim is formation of virtue and wisdom through a gospel-centered classical framework, not merely job training. The Vision emphasizes transformation “by the gospel and sharpened by rigorous academic pursuit,” aimed at cultural reformation and servant leadership. - The philosophy text and mission repeatedly link truth, goodness, and beauty with formation, character, and human flourishing; the site frames education as formation rather than information. - The site explicitly notes a non-career-prep stance in the sense that they are not a college-prep institution, while still pursuing rigorous academics for human excellence. This distinction clarifies telos as formation and virtue rather than purely job readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, classical mission, governance by a transcendent order. - Negative keywords present: references to “career readiness” or “workforce preparation” are explicitly rejected in public statements about the school’s aims (i.e., not a purely college-prep trajectory). This constitutes a negative signal for a job-skills emphasis but a positive signal for formation-focused goals.

Why this rating - The school’s purpose centers on virtue, wisdom, and formation with a teleological orientation toward moral and spiritual aims, not merely instrumental outcomes. The integration of gospel formation, classical aims, and emphasis on transcendentals (truth/goodness/beauty) all fit the Positive keyword set for a CLASSICAL rating, while the explicit disavowal of “career-prep” signals aligns with the intended formation focus. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly framed around the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric. The school describes the Grammar Stage (pre-K through elementary) and Dialectic Stage (grades 6–8) with a focus on structure, argumentation, and rhetoric. - There is a clear emphasis on Great Books and an integrated liberal-arts approach, including reading lists and resources linked to classical Christian curricula (Dorothy Sayers, Circe Institute, Veritas Press, Memoria Press, etc.). - Latin is highlighted as part of the classical curriculum, and history is treated within a liberal-arts context rather than as “social studies” per se. The navigation and content emphasize foundational classical subjects and methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, classical, liberal arts, Latin, history (as Western civilization/chronology), Circe/Veritas/Memoria (classical resources), Great Conversation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public-facing materials; no signs of substituting history with “social studies” or reducing classical core content.

Why this rating - The material strongly aligns with a CLASSICAL curriculum through explicit Trivium framing, Great Books/readings, liberal-arts emphasis, and classical-language study. The absence of negative signals from the published materials keeps this category solidly CLASSICAL. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Graded pedagogy is described as a mix of contemplative/restful practices in early years and Socratic/seminar-style dialogue in upper grades, with emphasis on rhetoric and speech in older students. The Grammar Stage emphasizes memorization via singing/chanting; upper grades emphasize dialectic and rhetoric. - The lower grades are described as engaging in singing and chanting to deepen memory and delight, reflecting a pedagogical emphasis on memory, recitation, and ritualized practice. - The public materials frame education as forming character and virtue through disciplined study and classical methods, with the living-curriculum concept implied by staff modeling and the integrated approach to learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé (restful learning), chanting, memory, narration/recitation, dialogue/seminar, rhetoric, formal debate, formation through the arts, living books, great conversations. - Negative keywords present: no strong signals of exclusive project-based, experiential, or constructivist pedagogy; the explicit emphasis on memory, recitation, and dialectic helps avoid the common negative signals.

Why this rating - Pedagogical approach is clearly aligned with classical practice: contemplative/restful elements in lower grades, memory-based tradition, and upper-grade engagement in Socratic-style dialogue and rhetoric. This pattern matches the Positive keyword indicators for a CLASSICAL rating, with no clear counter-signals in the public-facing materials. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Vision & Faith materials describe faculty as models of virtue and character, with staff portrayed as living exemplars in the school's mission; the site emphasizes the staff as a source of moral leadership within the school's culture. - The site references "Faculty & Staff" as a dedicated section, indicating a close relationship between teaching and the school's mission (i.e., living the curriculum and embodying the classical ideals). - There is emphasis on a community of like-minded educators and a notion of ministry through teaching (as part of the overall formation and discipleship framework).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers/mentors, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, character formation, mentorship, virtue, wisdom (as reflected in the school's framing of staff, discipleship, and teachers' roles). - Negative keywords present: no explicit signals of non-classical faculty norms (e.g., "certification-driven" or purely technical roles) appearing in the public-facing materials. The content frames faculty as moral exemplars and mentors.

Why this rating - The materials present faculty as the core of the living curriculum, with a focus on virtue, mentorship, and personal formation. This aligns with Positive keyword indicators for CLASSICAL and lacks any overt negative signals. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and regards them as co-teachers with school teachers; the parent role is described as central to forming the home environment in alignment with classical education. - The site invites parental involvement and formation, including references to family formation and classical book reading; it explicitly notes that parents are welcome to visits and to participate in the educational process. - Materials describe a program that educates parents in the classical approach (e.g., through book studies, gatherings), aligning with parent formation and partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, classical book clubs, open campus/visits, family liturgy alignment, household worship (as implied by the Christian formation context). - Negative keywords present: no consumer-language signals or minimal parental involvement; the materials instead promote active parental engagement and formation.

Why this rating - The emphasis on parent partnership, parental formation, and open access for visits demonstrates a CLASSICAL alignment in the Parents & Community category. The explicit framing of parents as co-educators and the commitment to parental formation align with Positive keyword indicators. CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL and no SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status requires needle-moving changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.